

THE RUMOR MILL

Where the official version is missing, an invented one moves in.

How to cut the rumor mill without becoming the police.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

And the invented one is always worse than the real one.

THE CASCADE

What happens when the leader turns sheriff.



WHAT YOU SEE

You hear the rumor and go looking for who said it...



THE MECHANISM

...the conversation migrates to smaller, closed groups...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and you lose the little information that still reached you.

Chasing the messenger does not erase the message, it only hides it better.

THE FORK

Before reacting, find what was missing.

WHAT WAS MISSING

01

Does the rumor answer a legitimate question? The vacuum is yours.

02

Is it about fear of losing something? Context and a date were missing.

03

Is it a pure personal attack? Then it is an individual conversation.

Most of what gets called gossip is a question with no official answer.

THE METHOD

The four vacuums that breed rumor.

01 **DECISION WITH NO REASON**

everyone knows what changed, nobody knows why

02 **CHANGE WITH NO DATE**

the team fills the empty calendar with the worst hypothesis

03 **REVIEW WITH NO CRITERIA**

with no visible yardstick, promotion becomes a conspiracy theory

04 **EXIT WITH NO CONTEXT**

someone vanishes from the org chart and nobody explains

| All four are leadership omissions, not people's defects.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

The right answer for each type.

01 • DECISION
WITH NO REASON

Decision.

tell the why and what was weighed, not only the outcome

02 • CHANGE
WITH NO DATE

Change.

give the date, and also say when there will be no news

03 • REVIEW
WITH NO
CRITERIA

Review.

public criteria before the cycle, never after the result

04 • EXIT WITH
NO CONTEXT

Exit.

you communicate it, the same day, with respect for whoever left

TWO MODELS

Policing or informing.

THE COMMON MODEL

Policing

Hunts whoever talked

Asks people to stop discussing it

Treats the symptom, keeps the cause

The conversation goes underground

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Informing

Finds the question behind it

Answers before being asked

Closes the vacuum that bred the rumor

The conversation comes back to the table

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that manufacture rumors.

01 Telling a chosen group first.

- whoever heard later understands there are two categories of people.

02 Announcing a change by email, with no conversation.

- text with no face becomes free interpretation in ten minutes.

03 Taking two weeks to explain the obvious.

- in that gap, the hallway version has already become the official one.

You do not compete with gossip on content, you compete on speed.

THE CHAIN

The gap test.

01 Measure the time between the decision being made...



02 ...and it being explained to the team.



03 That gap is exactly the space the rumor mill occupies.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Shrink the gap and the rumor mill loses its audience on its own.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

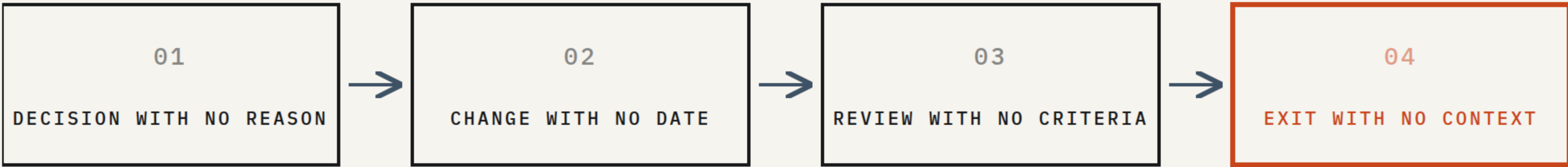
How to close the vacuums this week.

▣ STEP 01 List the three questions the team would ask if they could. if you do not know what they are, that is already the first finding	▣ STEP 02 Answer one of them at the next meeting, unprompted. getting ahead of the information is the single best rumor killer	■ STEP 03 Talk one to one with whoever feeds the mill most. no accusation, understanding what they are trying to find out
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| A leader who informs early does not have to police later.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Vacuums, in the order that matters.



Gossip is not fought with police. It is fought with information arriving first.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

in the next decision that has not been explained yet.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA